

# Gamification

How experiences draw us in

Club Meeting - 9/22

# Please Sign In!



This will be shown again at the end of the meeting too!

While you wait, enjoy this chrome dino :)





# Gamification

gam·i·fi·ca·tion ,gā-mə-fə-'kā-shən

: the process of adding games or gamelike elements to something (such as a task) so as to encourage participation

Source: <https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/gamification>



# In other words...

Making someone interested in doing something by  
making it *feel* like a **game**.

# Why do this?

- Some tasks are just inherently boring
  - Think filing taxes, memorizing vocab, brushing your teeth
  - We know we *need* to do them to be responsible adults, but they aren't enticing on their own
- Gamifying tasks artificially increases the user's sense of **reward**
  - The task remains as hard as it was, but the user feels they can *justify* its worth
  - Reframes the task into a fun **challenge**, rather than just feeling like homework
  - **Example:** Using a *streak* to get a user to study a bit of Spanish every day



# What makes a task gamifiable?



- Gamifying tasks tends to be most effective when the given task fits within these categories:
  - **Consistent Repetition:**
    - Tasks that repeat can feel dull if they result in the same outcome every time
    - Gamifying these tasks by adding **XP**, **levels**, or **streaks** can make each repetition feel like *progress*
  - **Clear Goals:**
    - In order for a user to be rewarded, a task needs to be *quantifiable*
    - There needs to be a clear completion point, so the system can provide instant feedback (success or failure)

# What makes a task gamifiable?



- Gamifying tasks tends to be most effective when the given task fits within these categories:
  - **Opportunity for Mastery:**
    - If a user can see an end in sight, they are far more likely to stay motivated
    - They can see their own growth, whether through progress bars or by counting the number of steps completed
  - **Variable Levels of Difficulty:**
    - Scaling difficulty can keep a user in a *flow state*, where they don't feel the task is too easy or too hard
    - This will keep them **engaged** without feeling **frustrated**

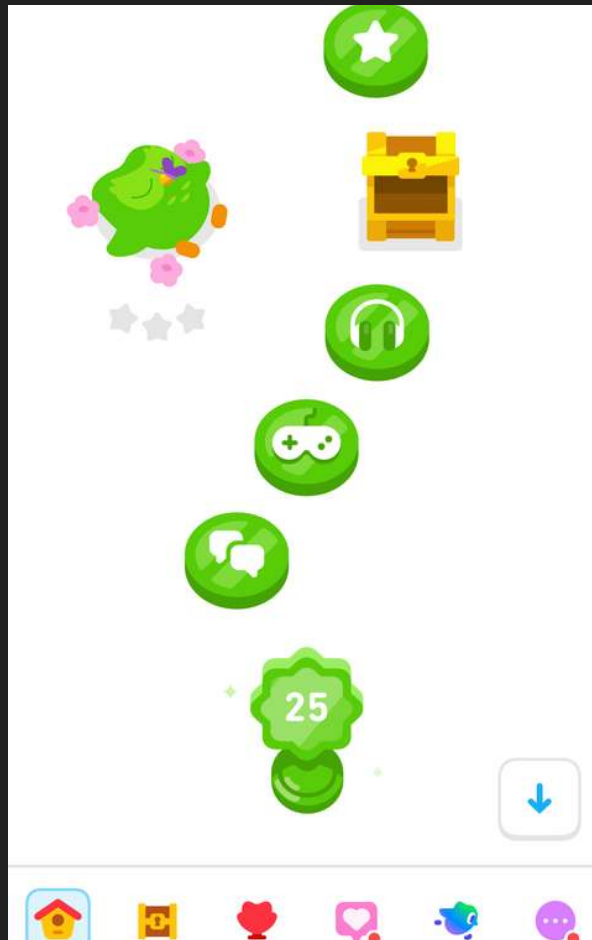
# The Gold Standard



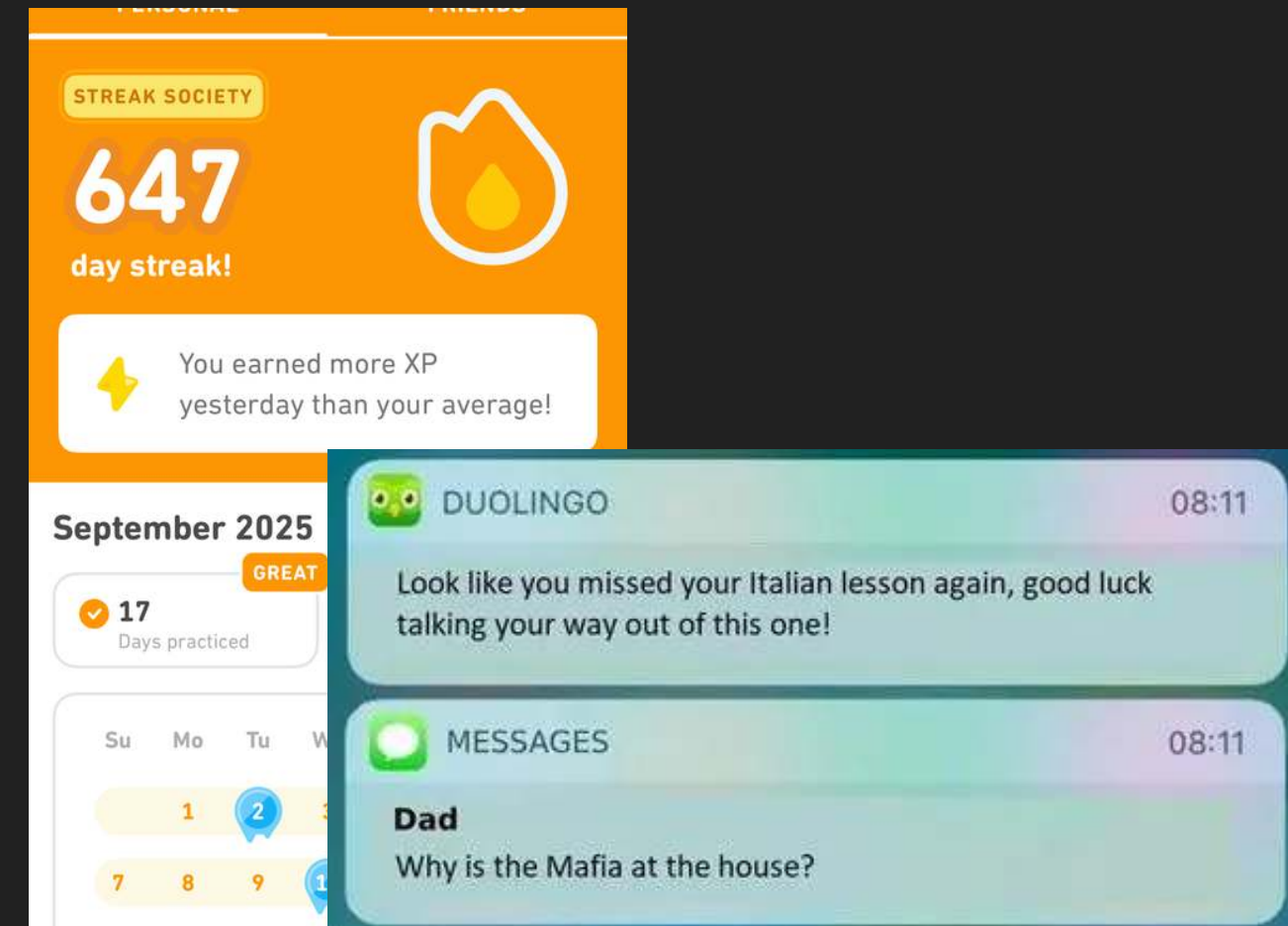
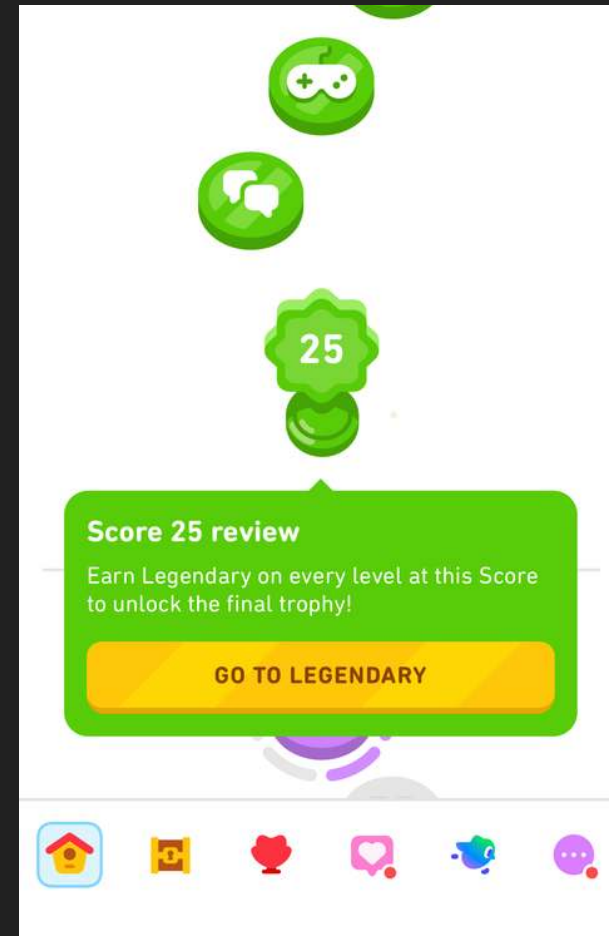
**Duolingo!**  
(A Pittsburgh Icon)

# Duolingo has it all

It's really the only example you need. It's *seriously* impressive how many game mechanics they crammed into this app.



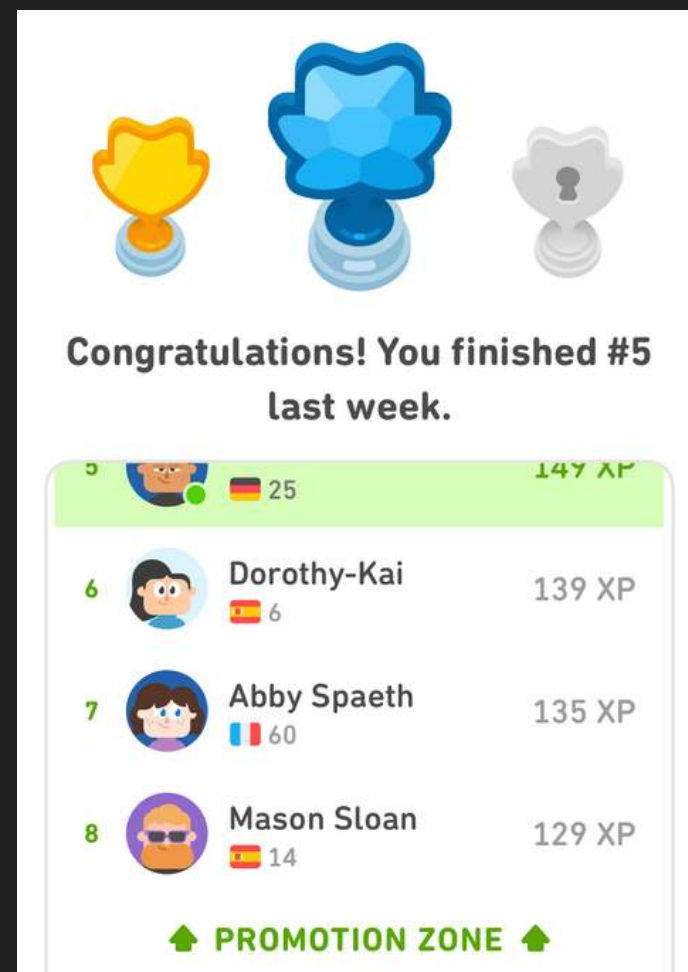
**Progress & Mastery**



**Habit Formation**

# Duolingo has it all

It's really the only example you need. It's seriously impressive how many game mechanics they crammed into this app.

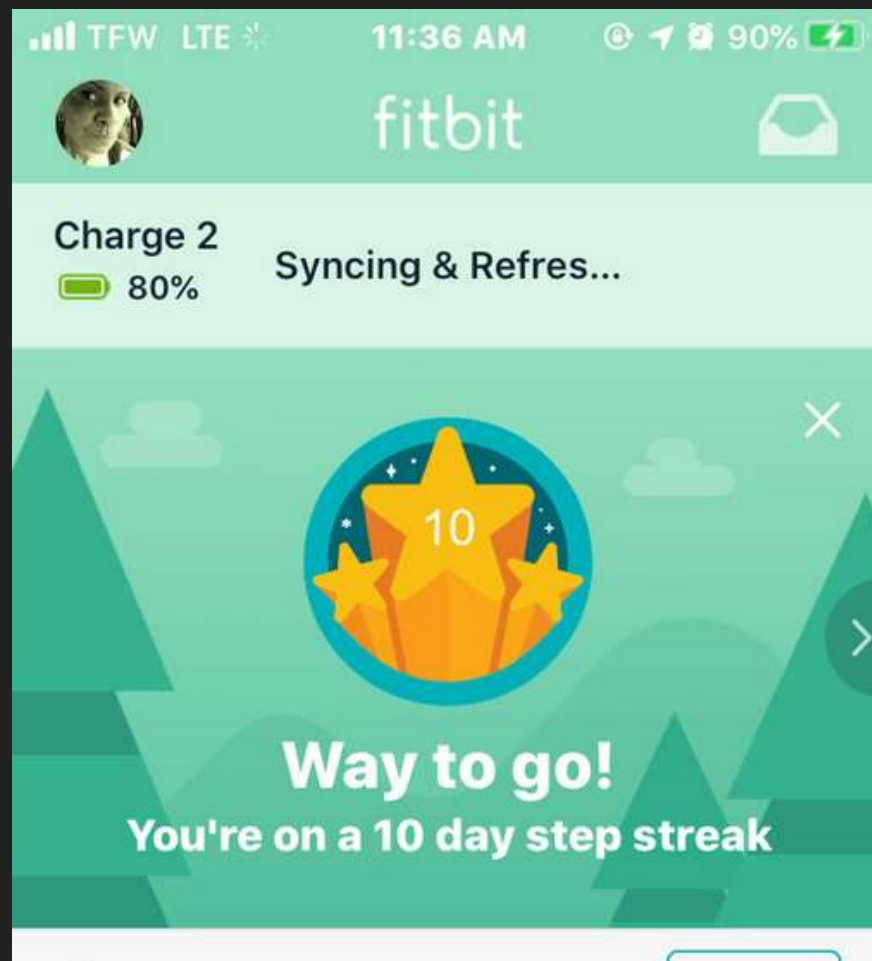


**Social Motivation**



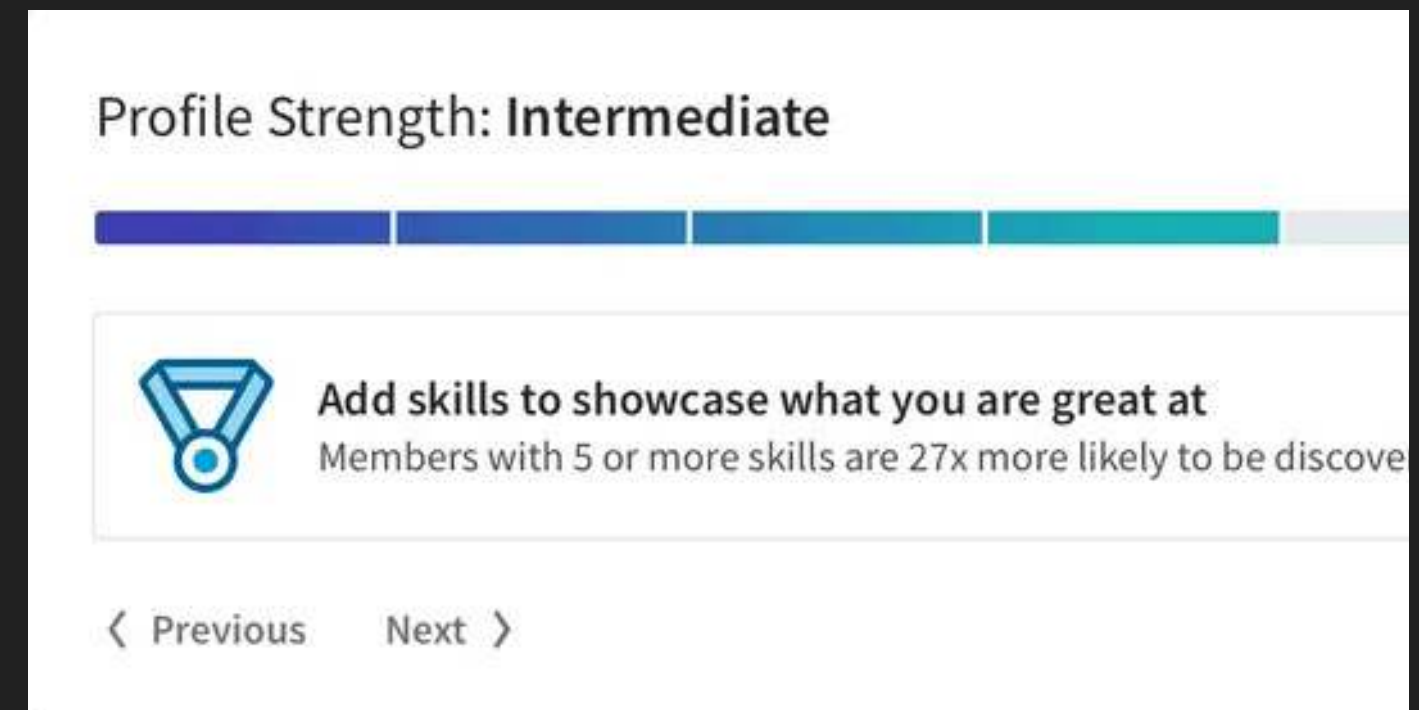
**Emotional Engagement**

# Some other examples



## Fitbit

Badges and challenges *motivate* users to build towards healthy habits



## LinkedIn

Profile strength meter *motivates* users to complete their profile

# Keep an eye on the action verb.



## “**motivation**”

Whenever you’re wondering whether to gamify an experience, think: “Is the user lacking intrinsic ***motivation***?”



# Now, it's your turn!

Time to build an app.

# Workshop Time!

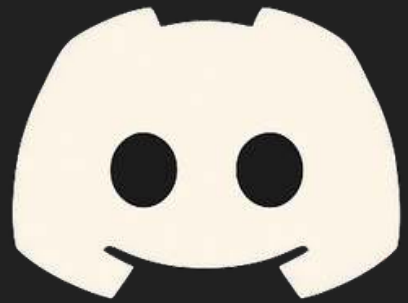
**Activity:** Redesign a boring/unengaging experience using gamification.

- Break into small groups (2-3 people per group)
- Pick a *mundane* task (brushing teeth, filing taxes, reading for class, recycling)
- Build an app around this task, incorporating **at least 3** gamification mechanics
- Here are a few examples...
  - **Progression systems** (levels, visual progress)
  - **Social competition/collaborations** (leaderboards, team goals)
  - **Rewards/badges** (milestones)
  - **Streaks/habit tracking**
  - **A central character/narrative** (mascot, guide, avatar)
- Afterwards, each group will present their *gamified concept*
- Did the idea end up cohesive? What are some potential pitfalls that could come from implementing this idea?

# Ways to Contact Us!



**@uxdpitt**



**UXD Discord Server**



**lbs57@pitt.edu**

# Thank you for coming!

Sign In Form



Discord Server

